

Project XTC – Development Edition 0.1

Chapter 5 – The SELECT Button: The Centre of the X-Touch Universe

If there is one button that unlocks the way the X-Touch works with Bitwig, it is SELECT. New users often think the controller follows whichever fader they touched most recently. In reality, DrivenByMoss revolves around a much simpler idea: the selected track. Once you understand that concept, many other features suddenly make sense.

Selection Is Intent

Pressing SELECT does not simply highlight a track. It tells Bitwig, 'this is where I want to work now.' Device Mode, Browser Mode, automation, Remote Controls and many navigation functions all begin with the currently selected track.

The Spotlight Analogy

Imagine a theatre stage. Dozens of actors are waiting, but only one is illuminated by the spotlight. The spotlight does not change the actor—it changes your attention. SELECT performs the same role inside Bitwig. It tells DrivenByMoss which track should receive your attention next.

Following the Conversation

A typical sequence looks like this:

1. Press SELECT on the Lead Synth track.
2. The scribble strips update to reflect that choice.
3. Press DEVICE.
4. The V-Pots become synth parameters.
5. Adjust the sound.
6. Return to Mixer Mode and continue mixing.

Notice that every step flows naturally because the selected track never becomes ambiguous.

Why This Design Works

Without a selected track, the controller would constantly have to guess your intentions. Should the encoders control the drums, the bass or the lead synth? By making the choice explicit, Bitwig and the X-Touch always agree on the current focus.

Common Mistakes

If turning an encoder affects the 'wrong' device, don't immediately suspect a bug. Check these two things: Is the correct track selected? Am I in the mode I think I'm in? Those two questions solve most day-to-day mysteries.

Field Note #007

Many experienced users press SELECT almost without thinking. Over time it becomes a habit: Select → Choose Mode → Adjust → Continue. Once that rhythm develops, mouse use drops dramatically because Bitwig always knows where your attention is focused.

Exercise

Create a project with four instrument tracks. Select each one in turn and enter Device Mode. Observe how the scribble strips, encoder labels and LED rings change while the hardware itself remains exactly the same. The only thing that has changed is Bitwig's focus.

Key Takeaways

- SELECT tells Bitwig where you intend to work.
- Most advanced functions begin with the selected track.
- Think 'Select → Mode → Adjust'.
- If something behaves unexpectedly, verify the selected track before anything else.